

AARON SCHERF

theaaronscherf@gmail.com • <https://www.linkedin.com/in/aaron-scherf/> • <https://aaronscherf.github.io/>

WORK EXPERIENCE

U.S. Agency for International Development

06/2020 – 07/2025

Foreign Service Officer - Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning Team Lead (FS 3-5)
Kyiv, Ukraine

- Managed portfolio of 20 program evaluations, including leading design of a \$1.5M randomized control trial to evaluate impact and cost effectiveness of \$450M credit facilitation program for small farmers
- Developed analytics system to track \$5Bn in electrical infrastructure support by administrative geography, enabling rapid repairs in response to Russian missile strikes and increased accountability

U.S. Agency for International Development

06/2020 – 07/2025

Foreign Service Officer - Gender Equity and Program Design Officer (FS 4-9)
Bogotá, Colombia

- Led the design and context research for four programs in smallholder agriculture, environmental conservation, rural land titling, and indigenous civic society leadership
- Developed system to process high-resolution drone imagery for land titling in flood-prone rural areas

U.S. Agency for International Development

06/2020 – 07/2025

Foreign Service Officer - Program Officer Rotations (FS 5-12)
Washington, DC, USA

- Developed new budget data processing and visualization tool using Python and Tableau, saving hundreds of hours of staff time in negotiations with State Department
- Led knowledge management pilot program with South Sudan office, including designing staff transition resources and implementation plan for improving handovers and file management in Juba

University of California, Berkeley

08/2018 – 05/2020

Graduate Student Instructor
Berkeley, CA, USA

- Designed and taught empirical research methods in Stata seminar for 40 MPP and MPA students, including research support for capstone projects
- Developed and taught labs on intermediate data science techniques in Python for undergraduates, including office hours and project support

Berkeley Food Institute

09/2019 – 03/2020

Agriculture and Hydrology Research Analyst
Berkeley, CA, USA

- Developed geospatial model analyzing groundwater and rainfall data compared with agricultural land-use for California's Central Valley, to support legislative reform and efficient water management

Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW)

11/2017 – 07/2018

Graduate Research Fellow - Migration and Labor Economics
Mannheim, Germany

- Analyzed panel data to model effects of asylum seekers' education level and living conditions on employment outcomes using GMM and instrumental variable methods in Stata
- Co-authored research paper in German on refugee integration strategies in Rhine-Neckar region for presentation to city councils in Heidelberg and Mannheim

EDUCATION

Columbia University

- PhD in Sustainable Development
- New York, NY, USA • 08/2026 – Present

Georgia Institute of Technology

- Master of Science in Computer Science • GPA: 3.88
- Atlanta, GA, USA • 01/2022 – 12/2025

Indiana State University

- Master of Science in Mathematics • GPA: 3.85
- Terre Haute, IN, USA • 05/2021 – 05/2024
- Thesis: Novel Omnibus Normality Test and Power Comparison with the Shapiro-Wilk

University of California, Berkeley

- Master of Science in Development Practice • GPA: 3.94
- Berkeley, CA, USA • 07/2018 – 05/2020
- Thesis: Predicting the Yield of CIMMYT Wheat Genotypes via Remote Sensing and Machine Learning

Heidelberg University

- Master of Science (audited) in Economics
- Heidelberg, DE • 07/2017 – 06/2018

Mercer University

- Bachelor in Finance and Economics • GPA: 3.91
- Macon, GA, USA • 08/2013 – 05/2017

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- Donald M. Payne Fellow (05/2017) — \$100,000 fellowship with USAID
- Fulbright Scholar (05/2017) — Research Fellow at ZEW / Heidelberg, DE
- Humanity in Action Senior Fellow (05/2017) — in partnership with Amnesty International
- Stamps Foundation Leadership Scholar (05/2013) — \$240,000 merit scholarship

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

- Applications of PCA for Mapping Regional Socioeconomic Vulnerability Indices (12/2019) — UC Berkeley: Data for Human Mobility Lab
- Integration Progress: Results from two Reallabor Surveys of Asylum Seekers (08/2018) — Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW) ([link](#))
- Gentrification or Revitalization? Ethical Investment in Urban Property Development (04/2017) — National Conference on Undergraduate Research
- Economic Impact Assessment of Historic Property Rehabilitation in Macon, GA (04/2017) — Society of Business, Industry, and Economics Conference
- “OurBlock” - Blockchain Based Property Registry for South African Land Reform (03/2017) — Harvard Social Entrepreneurship Pitch Competition
- “How to Kill a Microfinance Fund” – Analysis of Microcredit Policy in South Africa (10/2016) — Southern Conference Undergraduate Research Forum
- “Bloomfield 2020” – Neighborhood Economic Development Plan (04/2016) — Clinton Global Initiative University at Berkeley, CA

SKILLS

Computer Programming and Artificial Intelligence: Python, R, JavaScript, Stata, MatLab, Excel, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Artificial Neural Networks

Applied Economic Research: GIS Analysis (ArcGIS / GEE), Applied Econometrics, Mathematical Statistics, Labor Economic Research, Applied Mathematics, Development Economics

Languages and Other: Spanish - Professional, German - Intermediate, Program Evaluation, Empirical Policy Analysis, Information Communications Technology